Play the buffer

Quick musical guide - original MPC One / Hakai 3.9.1

A glitch instrument, not an ambient processor

GHOST intervenes in a drum loop with repeat, reverse, fragments and generative rhythmic changes. Start with low MIX, then increase it to hear the processed sound.

First minute

Save a project copy. Load GHOST as an insert on a Drum Program and play a simple loop. Enable LIVE REPEAT; change FRAGMENT. Turn Repeat off to recover the incoming groove. Try REVERSE after the buffer has incoming history.

What has actually been tested

The owner reports stable audio without unexpected dropouts/clicks on an original MPC One running Hakai 3.9.1. Whole-host CPU was about 16% without plugins and 30% with GHOST. This is not an audio-callback benchmark or certification for every preset, Q-Link or device.

Read before installing

Save your project, keep an independent backup and read INSTALL.md. Run the device-side install.sh with your actual Synths path. The corrected installer has offline simulation evidence; it has NOT been physically tested. The previously tested desktop package is a separate download.

PLAY and the six macros

Existing controls and sound are unchanged

ACTIVITY / CHARACTER

Activity governs how strongly Performance intervenes. Character governs variety and unpredictability; it is not another level control.

FRAGMENT / EVOLUTION

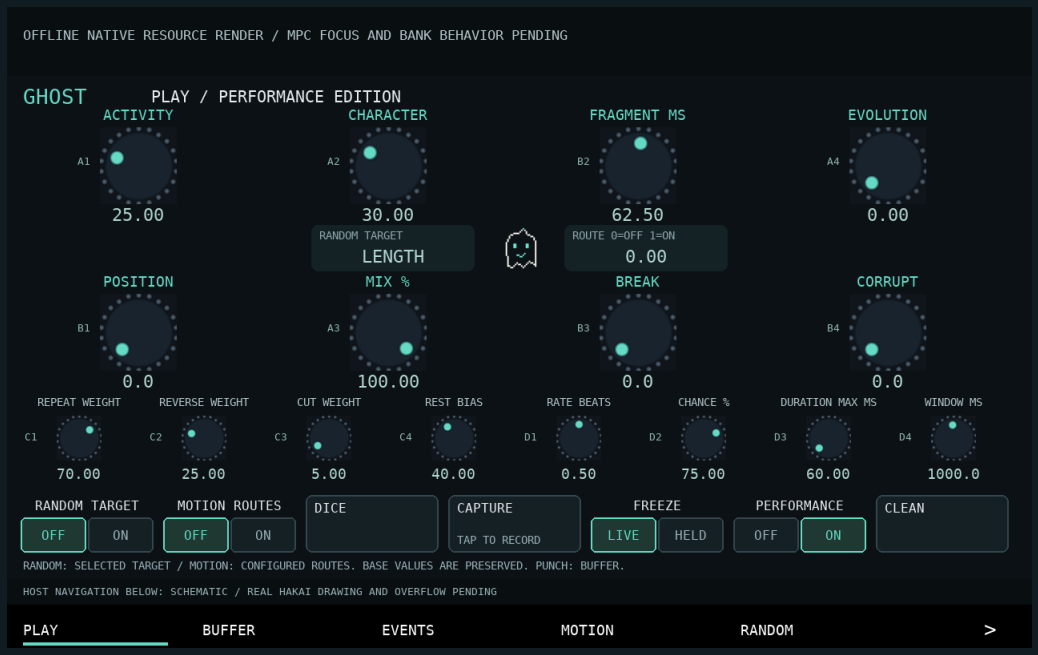
Fragment sets the time scale of repetition. Evolution uses existing Motion policy and routes; without an enabled route its effect may not be audible.

POSITION / MIX

Position selects buffer read position, not space or reverb. Mix blends the original and processed signal. Fully wet does not imply an active glitch event.

Touch and Q-Links

Use the existing native host pages, focus and Q-Link banks. The release does not remap Screen or Program assignments. Not every parameter is a continuously writable knob; some are actions or diagnostics.



Existing offline GUI preview; not a photograph or hardware validation.

LIVE, CAPTURE and HELD

Keep the incoming groove or protect a phrase

LIVE

Incoming audio continuously updates circular history. LIVE REPEAT pins a region; FRAGMENT changes its read length. Pinned material can keep repeating after input stops. LIVE REVERSE works on available history.

CAPTURE: two separate taps

First tap begins a latched take. Second tap confirms it and selects HELD. Capture duration is configurable up to eight seconds. Reaching the limit ends the take automatically and shows FULL; it does not keep overwriting that take.

FREEZE / HELD

Held material is protected from incoming audio until you replace or release it. Reverse is audible with retained audio. Mix still determines how much original versus processed signal you hear.

CLEAN and PUNCH / CANCEL

Clean stops processing and generation without erasing the retained take. PUNCH/CANCEL is a manual intervention, not a new recording command. Do not assume Clean deletes material or that generation will automatically resume.

Avoid surprises

A preset does not include a recorded phrase. Feed input or capture material before judging a buffer-dependent sound. Turn the mix down before trying unfamiliar destructive settings.

Random Repeat and BOTH

Generate phrases, then intervene by hand

INDEPENDENT

Random Repeat schedules Repeat on/off decisions and Fragment variations without the Performance engine. It uses the same manual-repeat reader that was physically validated.

PERFORMANCE and BOTH

Performance runs the existing generative engine. BOTH combines it with Random Repeat without cancelling the latter's length decisions. In BOTH, Activity zero cancels automatic Random Repeat.

Shape the phrase

Intensity and probability govern intervention. Variation changes fragment variety; Rate governs decision spacing; Hold keeps some repeats stable before another decision. Motion/Evolution depends on its enabled routing.

Manual control and reproducibility

Manual changes take priority for the existing override window; automatic generation can resume afterward. Fixed seeds with equivalent clock/control sequences are deterministic. Transport seeks/reset can intentionally restart the sequence.

Protect the take

Random Repeat and Performance do not destructively automate Capture or Freeze. Use Clean to stop generation. Keep project copies when experimenting with mode changes and new states.

Presets, installation, recovery

Keep the working instrument and your music safe

Programs and FXP

GHOST keeps 16 factory programs and 52 external FXP files. They do not contain captured audio. External FXP import into the Hakai browser is not established; copying them does not prove they appear automatically.

Project compatibility

New RRF1 states may not open in an older binary. Save under a new project name. File rollback is not project conversion. Public parameter indices, UID and Q-Links remain unchanged.

Two installer contracts

The original tested desktop controller runs Python and SSH on the computer and has its own watchdog and transaction backups. The proposed catalog installer runs shell scripts on the device. These are distinct packages; one does not prove the safety of the other.

Installation and rollback

Read INSTALL.md for device-side shell commands and your actual Synths path. Backups and rollback.sh stay outside GHOST under .ghost-recovery. Unknown or edited user files are retained; conflicting runtime changes refuse. The -n option leaves service recovery to the catalog batch caller. The installer itself is offline-tested only.

License and provenance

GPL-3.0-only with retained MIT framework/ABI/tool credits and DejaVu/Bitstream/stb notices. Knob artwork and original mascot sprites were independently regenerated and byte-verified in the source audit. No proprietary SDK or firmware artwork is bundled. Unofficial; no Akai/inMusic endorsement.